

remains

last night my brother told me
about the out-of-body experience he had
after ingesting too many of the edibles he bought
from the gas station off i80. not cali weed,
like i'm used to—called thc-a, only thing legal in nebraska.
looking down from the ceiling, he was god and saw himself.
he said it helped him process. i told him about grief.
while we were crying, i said that
you couldn't properly honor a thing until
you danced. but it was too raw. too soon.
so i sat there on the curb, a thousand miles away,
and told him of the time
when i opened up my contacts app, and
my finger froze.
paralyzed.
there was no one to call.
i chose to run away
but it's still there—the barely flickering streetlight overhead
reminds me of it. the loose thread on my canvas backpack strap
reminds me of it. the absence throbs at my side. my brother said
he sold the absinthe under his bed. “progress,” he said. but i don't
have the heart to tell him that there is no progress. i don't have
the heart to tell him that he's still using present tense.
the only thing i can say is that
when the grapefruit falls from the tree, bruised by the ground,
with nectar leaking from its gash,
and no one else is there—
you must put your nose to it.